THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 9 ENGLISH — READING SKILL PAPER SET 10

Reading Comprehension | RBSE Board Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 45 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 20**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Section A has one passage with 12 questions (1 mark each).
3. Section B has one case-based passage with 8 questions (1 mark each).
4. Questions include MCQs and short answers of 30–40 words.
5. Write the question number before each answer.
6. Answers must be written in the answer book in the order of the questions.

SECTION — A (Reading Comprehension: Factual / Discursive Passage, 400–450 words) 12 Marks

Read the passage and answer the questions.

1. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 12

Language is the thread that ties a community's memory together. Words carry the names of crops, the rhythm of festivals and the secrets of games played by children long ago. When a language disappears, an entire way of seeing the world goes with it.

India has twenty-two scheduled languages and hundreds of mother tongues. Some, like Hindi and Tamil, are spoken by millions. Others are spoken by only a few thousand people in remote valleys. Linguists warn that several of the smaller ones may vanish within a generation because young people shift to languages that offer jobs and wider reach.

When a language disappears, the loss is greater than a set of words. A tribal tongue may have thirty names for the stages of a single crop, or a song for each type of rain. Once its last speaker is gone, the knowledge held in those words goes with it, and no dictionary can bring it back. Linguists warn that nearly half of the world's languages may vanish within this century.

Yet there is reason for hope. Families in many places are teaching their mother tongues to children again, and schools are introducing folk songs and stories into the classroom. Technology, which often hurries languages towards silence, can also preserve them: recordings, fonts and mobile applications give small languages a place in the modern world. A language lives so long as someone is willing to speak it at home, and any child can be that someone.

Each of us can contribute. A grandmother's lullaby noted in a diary, a village proverb written on a school wall or a folk tale recorded on a phone is a small deposit in the bank of a community's memory. Young people who pride themselves on speaking several languages should include the language of their grandparents among them. Learning one more tongue is never a loss; it adds a new window to the mind. A person who can speak with the old and the young alike holds the living bridge on which a culture crosses into the future.

Preserving a language does not mean rejecting others. A child can speak her mother tongue at home, learn the language of her state at school and use English in higher studies. Each one opens a different door. Schools can keep folk songs, proverbs and stories of the locality alive in assemblies and festivals. Families can tell bedtime stories in the old tongue. A language that is spoken and sung will not easily die.

(i) The writer compares language to: 1

(a) a wall **(b)** a thread that ties memory together

(c) a river **(d)** a key

(ii) How many scheduled languages does India have? 1

(a) ten **(b)** twenty-two **(c)** forty **(d)** fifty

(iii) Small languages may vanish because young people: 1

(a) write more **(b)** dislike old people

(c) shift to languages that offer jobs and reach **(d)** travel

(iv) According to the passage, a child can: 1

(a) use several languages for different purposes **(b)** avoid English

(c) know only one **(d)** forget her mother tongue

(v) A language will not easily die if it is: 1

(a) written once **(b)** taught only in colleges

(c) locked in books **(d)** spoken and sung

(vi) What do words carry in a language? 1

(vii) Give one way schools can help to preserve languages. 1

(viii) How can families help? 1

(ix) Find a word that means 'to disappear'. 1

(x) What does the writer mean by 'each one opens a different door'? 1

(xi) Linguists warn that nearly half of the world's languages: 1

(a) are growing rapidly **(b)** are already extinct

(c) are easy to preserve **(d)** may vanish within this century

(xii) How can technology help small languages? 1

SECTION — B (Reading Comprehension: Case-based Passage, 200–250 words) — 8 Marks

Read the text and answer the questions.

2. *Read the following case and answer the questions that follow.* 8

Class 9 students of a school in Udaipur took part in a heritage walk organised by the local tourism club. They started at the City Palace at 8 a.m., walked down to the lake shore and ended at an old step-well in the market. A guide named Mr Salim led the walk and explained the history of each place. He pointed out that the palace had been built over nearly 400 years by successive rulers, each adding a new wing in the style of his own time.

At the lake, the students learnt about the system of canals and tanks through which medieval engineers brought water to the city. Mr Salim explained that the step-well was designed to remain cool in summer and to store water for long periods. Students noted that its steps seemed to go down endlessly, with carved pillars on both sides.

The walk ended at 11:30 a.m. with a quiz. Each student was asked to write a short paragraph on the monument he or she liked best. Mr Salim announced that the three best paragraphs would be printed in the club's newsletter, and he reminded everyone that monuments are fragile. 'Do not write on walls or throw litter,' he said. 'They belong to all of us, today and tomorrow.'

(i) The heritage walk began at the: 1

(a) market **(b)** step-well **(c)** lake shore **(d)** City Palace

(ii) The palace was built over nearly: 1

(a) 400 years **(b)** 100 years **(c)** 40 years **(d)** 4 years

(iii) The step-well was designed to remain: 1

(a) open at night **(b)** dry in rain

(c) cool in summer **(d)** warm in winter

(iv) The best paragraphs would be printed in the: 1

(a) newspaper **(b)** club's newsletter

(c) magazine of the palace **(d)** school diary

(v) Who led the walk? 1

(vi) How did the palace get its present form? 1

(vii) How long did the walk last? 1

(viii) What did the guide ask the students to do to protect monuments? 1

END OF QUESTION PAPER **Total: 20 Marks**

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